Lingala NLP Datathon

Volunteer Author Consent Form

Project	Strathmore NLP Hub Datathon – Lingala NLP Project
Purpose	Development and evaluation of Lingala natural language processing resources.

1. About the project

We are developing a Lingala NLP dataset to explore how well language technology handles natural, everyday Lingala expressions.

We are inviting Lingala-speaking volunteers to contribute original written Lingala sentences and expressions that reflect how the language is naturally used in everyday communication.

2. What participation involves

As a volunteer author, you will be asked to:

- Write original Lingala sentences and expressions.
- Contribute approximately **16–17 test records**, depending on the assigned allocation.
- Use natural, conversational Lingala rather than relying exclusively on literal translations.
- Review your contributions for spelling, meaning and naturalness.
- Avoid including personal information or identifying details in submitted records.

Participation is voluntary.

3. Permission to use contributions

By participating, you grant the project team permission to:

- Store your submitted language contributions in the project dataset.
- Edit formatting and anonymise contributions where necessary.
- Use the contributions for academic research, NLP model testing and evaluation.
- Include the contributions in project demonstrations and reports.
- Publish the contributions in a project repository, if the dataset is subsequently made public.

Your contributions will be attributed using a **pseudonymous author code** rather than your personal identity.

4. Privacy and confidentiality

Please do not include:

- Personal telephone numbers.
- School admission or registration numbers.
- Full names or identifiable personal details.
- Private conversations belonging to other people without their permission.
- Sensitive personal information.

The project will use pseudonymous author codes (for example, **T07-V1**) in its internal records and dataset.

A separate private source log will be maintained for research documentation. It will not be included in the public dataset.

5. Voluntary participation

You may decline to participate or withdraw before your contributions are incorporated into a published or released dataset.

If you wish to withdraw, contact the project coordinator using the communication channel through which you were recruited.

Once contributions have been incorporated into a publicly released dataset, complete removal from copies already downloaded or redistributed may not be possible.

6. Consent confirmation

By agreeing below, I confirm that:

- I understand the purpose of this project.
- I understand what is expected of me as a volunteer author.
- I have been informed how my contributions may be used.
- I voluntarily permit the project team to use my contributions under the conditions described above.
- I understand that my identity will not be included in the dataset.

Volunteer pseudonymous code	_____
Date	_____
Confirmation method	[ ] Written confirmation [ ] Digital confirmation
Consent	[ ] I voluntarily agree to participate.

Project contact: Project Coordinator – Lingala NLP Datathon